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Aranya Chakraborty

CONTACT INFORMATION

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POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Economics and Public Policy — June 30, 2023 - Present
Amrut Mody School of Management
Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, India

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, **McGill University**, Montreal, Canada — 2023
Dissertation Title: *Learning and Technology Adoption in Developing Countries*
Committee: Sonia Laszlo (Supervisor), Francesco Amodio (Co-Supervisor), Matthieu Chemin.

M.Sc. in Economics, **University of Calcutta**, Kolkata, India — 2016
B.Sc. in Economics (Honours), **R.K.M.R College Narendrapur**, Kolkata, India — 2014

RESEARCH FIELDS

Development Economics, Information Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

WORKING PAPERS

"Network-Based Targeting with Heterogeneous Agents for Improving Technology Adoption," May 2026. [**Revised and Resubmitted (2nd round) to the Journal of Development Economics**]

"The Role of Active Discussion in Coordinating about Uncertain Technologies," February 2026. (with Javier Escobal, Sonia Laszlo, and Jim Warnick)

"Learning from Experience about Product Design: Evidence from Index Insurance in Kenya," February 2026.

"Lessons from the Past: How Experience Reduces the Impact of Weather Shocks on Ugandan Smallholders," November 2025. (with Giuseppe Maggio and Fabio G. Santeramo)

"Inefficiency in Agricultural Production: Do Information Frictions Matter?" June 2025. (with Digvijay Singh Negi and Rahul Rao)

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

"Food Transfers in a Primitive Economy: Comparing Three Models of Risk-Sharing in Networks." (with Francesco Amodio and Pau Milán)

BOOK CHAPTERS

"Food Insecurity, Price Volatility and Trade: A Panel Data Analysis in Developing Countries," *Chapter-10 in Indian Agriculture under Multilateral and Regional Trade Agreements - Competitiveness and Food Security, Sharma and Bathla (eds.), CWS in association with Bookwell, Delhi, 2017, 177-194.* (with Panchanan Das and Swayambhu Mukherjee)

OTHER PAPERS

"Industrial Performance in West Bengal: Analysis of Technical Efficiency with ASI Data," August 2016. (with Panchanan Das and Swayambhu Mukherjee)

MEDIA/POSTS

"Information is power: ICT and agricultural productivity," *Ideas for India*, April 2025. (with Digvijay Singh Negi and Rahul Rao)

"Using Social Ties to Improve Technology Adoption: Does Heterogeneity Matter?" August 2023.

Teaching Experience

Ahmedabad University (Instructor)

FYS124 - Connected Choices: How Networks Shape Our Decisions, Winter 2026
ECO220 - Econometrics, Monsoon 2024-25
ECO321/ECO620 - Empirical Research Methods in Economics, Winter 2024-25 & Monsoon 2025
ECO100 - Microeconomics, Monsoon 2023-24

McGill University (Teaching Assistant)

ECON 313 - Economic Development 1, Winter 2021-23 & Fall 2021
ECON 314 - Economic Development 2, Winter 2019-20 & Winter 2022
ECON 306 - Labor Markets and Wages, Fall 2022
ECON 416 - Topics in Economic Development 2, Winter 2021
ECON 473 - Income Distribution, Winter 2021 & Fall 2021
ECON 305 - Industrial Organization, Fall 2019
ECON 230D1 - Microeconomic Theory, Fall 2018
ECON 227D2 - Economic Statistics, Winter 2018
ECON 310 - Introduction to Behavioural Economics, Fall 2017 & Fall 2020

Visiting Positions

Visiting Researcher — June 8, 2026 - June 15, 2026
School of Economics
University of Barcelona, Barcelona, Spain

Visiting Professor — May 30, 2024 - June 21, 2024
Department of Economics
McGill University, Montreal, Canada

Visiting Scientist — March 1, 2024 - March 15, 2024
Economics and Planning Unit
Indian Statistical Institute, New Delhi, India

Research Grants and Scholarships

2026-28: SSHRC Canada Insight Development Grant - Co-Investigator, *C*$ 82,621.

2023-26: Ahmedabad University Conference Travel Support.

2025: Econometric Society Travel Grant (to present at the ESWC2025), $ 2,000.

2022: Graduate Research Enhancement and Travel (GREAT) Award, Faculty of Arts, McGill University.

2022: Conference Student Travel Grant, Canadian Economics Association (to present at the CEA 2022).

2019: McCall MacBain Fellowship, McGill University.

2018-2022: Doctoral Fellowship, McGill University.

2017-2021: Graduate Excellence Award, McGill University.

Other Prizes and Awards

2024: Young Scholars' Best Paper Award by the CITD, JNU in the International Conference on "Recent Developments in Economic Research: Theory and Evidence."

2014: Prof. D. Datta Memorial Prize for First Class (First Position) in Economic Honours, R.K.M.R College Narendrapur.

Presentations

2026: Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society, East & Southeast Asia, Hanoi, Vietnam;
NOVAFRICA Conference on Economic Development at NOVA SBE, Lisbon, Portugal;
AMSOM Research Seminar Series at Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India;
2025: Symposium on Network Economics at IIM Bangalore, Bangalore, Karnataka, India;
Econometric Society World Congress 2025, Seoul, Korea;
EAYE Annual Meeting 2025 at King's College London, London, United Kingdom;
AMSOM Research Seminar Series at Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India;

2nd Meeting of Young Minds at IIT Bombay, Mumbai, Maharashtra, India;
Food and Agriculture Research Discussion Forum (FARDF) Meeting, Virtual;

2024: 19th ACEGD at ISI-Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, India;
Winter School 2024 at DSE, New Delhi, Delhi, India;
8th Annual CECFEE Research and Policy Workshop, Khajuraho, MP, India;
IIMB Seminar Series at IIM Bangalore, Bangalore, Karnataka, India;
Economics Department Seminar at Ashoka University, Sonipat, Haryana, India;
CIREQ Lunch Seminar at McGill University, Montreal, QC, Canada;
Empirical Reading Group Presentation at ISI-Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, India;
International Conference at CITD, JNU, New Delhi, Delhi, India.

2023: 18th ACEGD at ISI-Delhi, New Delhi, Delhi, India;
BREW-ESA 2023 at IIT Bombay, Mumbai, Maharashtra, India;
NEUDC Conference at Harvard University, Cambridge, MA, USA;
AMSOM Research Seminar Series at Ahmedabad University, Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India;
Far Siders Development Seminar (FSDS), Virtual;
Annual Meeting of the CEA, Virtual Session;
18th CIREQ PhD Students' Conference at Concordia University, Montreal, QC, Canada.

2022: McGill CPD-SSPD Seminar at McGill University, Montreal, QC, Canada;
17th CIREQ PhD Students' Conference at Concordia University, Montreal, QC, Canada;
Annual Meeting of the CEA at Carleton University, Ottawa, ON, Canada;
CIREQ Lunch Seminars at McGill University, Montreal, QC, Canada.

2015: CWS-IIFT Conference at IIFT, New Delhi, Delhi, India.

Professional Services

Referee Services

Journal of the European Economic Association, Economics of Education Review, Journal of Agricultural and Resource Economics, Arthaniti- Journal of Economic Theory and Practice, Journal of Advances in Management Research, Journal of Quantitative Economics, Food Security, Agriculture & Food Security

Other Services

Major Advisor, Bachelor of Arts in Economics, Ahmedabad University, 2026-Present;
Co-Coordinator, Research Seminar Series, AMSOM, Ahmedabad University, 2025-Present;
Member, Organizing Committee, 7th Annual Economics Conference, Ahmedabad University;
Member, Organizing Committee, Symposium on Network Economics, IIM Bangalore, 2025;
Member, Organizing Committee, 6th Annual Economics Conference, Ahmedabad University;
Chair, Social Media Committee, AMSOM, Ahmedabad University, 2024-2025;
Member, MA (Economics) Curriculum Design Committee, AMSOM, Ahmedabad University, 2023;
Organizer, Applied Micro Breakfast, Dept. of Economics, McGill University, 2020-2021.

Languages

Bengali (native), Hindi (native), English (fluent).

Skills

Stata, R, Python, EViews, Matlab, LaTeX